

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*

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## Sue Venir

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*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

# INTRODUCTIONS



Sue Venir

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## *Cultural Property Attorney*

Sue corrects the fine print on dinner menus. Sue is the lawyer museums call when an object has three owners, four countries, six contradictory export documents, and one increasingly angry newspaper.

- Works with **Artie Ficial** and **Monet Bags** on museum contracts.
- Has argued opposite sides of restitution cases with **Mona Lott**. They're ruthless opponents but still besties.
- **Dr. Art E. Fact** supplies expert opinions for Sue's cases. Sue usually asks for a shorter version.

## **ACTING TIPS**

A lawyer with sass: precise, formidable, patient, amused by sloppy certainty. Ask pointed questions and answer only the question actually asked.

## **YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD**

I'm Sue Venir. Lovely to meet you. Nothing I say over dinner constitutes legal advice, although I will be keeping notes.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

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Sue Venir

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## Behind the portrait

### Your grievance with Grant

You wrote a private legal memorandum concluding that the Star Bowl's acquisition was too risky to defend confidently. Grant forced you to replace it with a softer opinion and planned to cite your name during the announcement.

### Your other secret

Both versions of the memo still exist. You kept the original instead of destroying it, which could expose you to professional embarrassment and Grant to serious scrutiny.

### Conversations to start

- Learn whether Mona Lott has obtained a copy of your original memo.
- Keep Dr. Art E. Fact from publicly speculating about your legal advice.

*One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.*

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

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# The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Find a chair that a magnet might fancy. Look beneath its seat.*
- 2 *Open the cupboard where ordinary things have been given a private gallery.*
- 3 *Look above the large door that admits the household vehicles.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

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## Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did Grant ask you to hide?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What did you want returned or protected?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

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*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

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Sue Venir

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## Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

### IF INNOCENT

I softened the legal opinion and failed to correct Grant when he called it clearance. Both versions still identify a problem with the title. He wanted my name in the announcement and my qualifications left out. I had let the account matter more than the advice. Hearing him use that compromise as my endorsement was unbearable.

### IF MURDERER

I softened the legal opinion and failed to correct Grant when he called it clearance. Both versions still identify a problem with the title. He wanted my name in the announcement and my qualifications left out. I had made myself useful to him by saying less. Now he expected my signature on a claim I did not believe.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**  
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme**

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid**

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

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**Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance**

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

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**Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks**

Describe your errand at the private service station.

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**Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates**

What physical work or problem occupied you?

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**Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic**

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

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**Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel**

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

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**Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist**

What practical museum duty were you handling?

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**Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher**

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

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**Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop**

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

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*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

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Sue Venir

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

I took a call from opposing counsel in the coatroom. Grant wanted my revised opinion read as clearance of the collection. It was not. I had softened the wording and failed to object when he described it that way. Counsel asked which version would be supplied to the board. I said both. Grant heard the end of that answer and told me there would be consequences for embarrassing his gift.

#### IF MURDERER

I took a call from opposing counsel in the coatroom. Grant wanted my revised opinion read as clearance of the collection. It was not. I had softened the wording and failed to object when he described it that way. Counsel asked which version would be supplied to the board. I said both. Grant heard the end of that answer and told me there would be consequences for embarrassing his gift.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**  
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

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# Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact**

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

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**Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist**

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

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**Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates**

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate**

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

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**Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher**

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

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**Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks**

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

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**Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop**

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote**

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

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**Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme**

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

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*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

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Sue Venir

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# Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I retained both legal opinions. The earlier one names the missing permit; the softened version does not withdraw that finding. My assistant's outgoing email has the earlier attachment. I let Grant describe a rewrite as a clearance. The file can show what I actually advised, even if I did not object loudly enough.

## IF MURDERER

I softened the legal opinion for Grant and kept the earlier version. He wanted me to call the ownership finding settled. I took the annex away before he could keep my name beside that claim. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my legal case. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved the glass to keep the signature page flat.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

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# Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

**Your character name**

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**I accuse**

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**Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction**

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**Best Actor**

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**Best Costume**

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**Sue Venir**

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## The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

### **IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED**

I softened the opinion and allowed Grant to imply it cleared the collection. The earlier version still names the missing permit. I did not kill him. Both opinions will go to the board, including the language I weakened. Advice becomes less useful when the lawyer helps a client conceal what it actually says.

### **IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED**

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my legal case when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He used my softened opinion as permission to keep what he could not prove he owned. I ended the argument by killing my client.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*